

Mono/Micro Triage Pack — 8 Cards

Day 1 · Activity 1 handout. Eight anonymized examples. For each, apply the three-question frame, then stamp a stance using the accompanying stamp sheet.

For each card, apply the three-question frame (deploy cadence · failure domain · scaling axis) and stamp one of: **Monolith fits** · **Microservice fits** · **Modular monolith fits** · **Need more info**.

Card 1

A startup's checkout flow at 50 customers, 1 backend team.

Card 2

A streaming service's recommendation engine at scale, 3 teams contributing.

Card 3

A new "saved searches" feature in a 2-year-old e-commerce monolith, owned by one squad.

Card 4

A payments processor that signs off on transactions for 14 internal apps.

Card 5

A reporting export that takes 3–10 minutes per report, run nightly.

Card 6

A real-time dispatcher pricing engine that all dispatch flows depend on.

Card 7

A small team's first internal tool, built next to the main app.

Card 8

A feature whose load triples every World Cup but is otherwise small.

Your protocol

1. **Stamp each card** (15 min) using the stamp sheet.
2. **Pick the 2 cards with the strongest case for separation**, and the **2 with the strongest case for staying together** (10 min).
3. **Identify 1 card where your triad disagreed** (10 min); be ready to explain the disagreement.

Readout (60 sec)

"The clearest case for separation was [X] because [reason]. The clearest case for staying together was [Y] because [reason]. We disagreed about [Z] — the unresolved question is [...]."